

Recap of last week:

Let's wrap up: functions of shots

Establishing shots

are typically long or extreme long shots of buildings or landscapes. These shots might include signage, landmarks, or other obvious signals of place and time.

A shot, usually involving a distant framing, that shows the spatial relations among the important figures, objects, and setting in a scene.



The title frame from Welles's tour de force establishing track at the beginning of *Touch of Evil* (1958)

(frame enlargement)



Orson Welles

In a few minutes, we know all that we need to know.



Rear Window 后窗

The establishing shot—a long shot—established place, often time, and sometimes other necessary information. Hitchcock was a master of the establishing shot. The opening pan and track of *Rear Window* (1954), for example, tells us where we are, why we are there, whom we are with, what is going on now, what has happened to get us there, who the other characters of the story are, and even suggests possible ways the story might develop—all effortlessly and quickly and without a spoken word! Paragraphs of prose are condensed into seconds of film time.



Master Shot

A scene from *Harry Potter*

Master shots and establishing shots both work to set up the relationship between a scene's subject and their location.

A master shot is a film recording of an entire dramatised scene, start to finish, from a camera angle that keeps all the players in view.

They are the necessary shots that helps you understand the events happening in any given scene. So, to include all of the cinematic information needed in your framing.

Balance

information

An **establishing shot** and a **master shot** serve different functions in film language, though they can sometimes overlap.

Establishing Shot

- A **wide or extreme wide shot** that introduces the setting, spatial relationships, and context of a scene.
- Primarily used at the beginning of a sequence to orient the audience.
- It does not necessarily include the main action but gives a sense of the environment.
- Example: A **city skyline shot** before cutting to a conversation inside an apartment.

Master Shot

- A **continuous shot that captures the entire scene**, often from a medium or wide distance.
- Includes all key characters and blocking, ensuring spatial continuity.
- Used as a reference shot, allowing filmmakers to cut to close-ups and inserts while maintaining spatial coherence.
- Example: A **wide shot of a dinner table conversation**, covering all characters before cutting to close-ups of individual speakers.

Function: The **establishing shot** provides location/context, while the **master shot** serves as coverage for the whole scene. **Placement:** The **establishing shot** is usually at the beginning, whereas the **master shot** runs throughout the scene. **Content:** The **establishing shot** might not include main characters, while the **master shot** always includes them.

A. Shot and space/spatial relations
(we will discuss it later, the 180-degree rule)

B. Shot and time/space



Beth's long-take arrival in Vegas

Instead of interrupting the action with frequent cuts, *The Queen's Gambit* favours thoughtful long takes, particularly when Beth makes a poised entrance or exit.

We will talk about long-take in detail. *Week 8.*

Speaking of these functions of shots:

it is about the function of one shot upon other shots

so, we need editing: to put shots together.

Week 7

Editing

The Relation of Shot



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Editing

After this lecture, you should:

1. Train your eye to be sensitive to these editing techniques.
2. Read and understand how to use those descriptive terms
3. Figure out how editing allows the filmmaker to manipulate time, space, and pictorial qualities in ways that shape the viewer's experience of the film.

The usage of terms: Etymology

In the U.S., the word for the work of putting together the shots of a film is "cutting" or "editing," while in Europe the term is "montage."

- The American words suggest a trimming process, in which unwanted material is eliminated.
- "Montage," however, suggests a building action, working up from the raw material.

Indeed, the classic style of Hollywood (when?) editing of the thirties and forties, revived in part in the eighties—what the French call *decoupage classique*—was in fact marked by its smoothness, fluidity, and leanness. And European montage, ever since the German Expressionists and Eisenstein in the twenties, has been characterized by a process of synthesis: a film is seen as being constructed rather than edited. The two terms for the action express the two basic attitudes toward it.

Decoupage classique, the Hollywood style of construction, gradually developed a broad range of rules and regulations:

- for example, the practice of beginning always with an establishing shot, then narrowing down from the generalization;
- or, the strict rule of thumb for editing dialogue scenes with master shots and reverse angles.
- or, the less motion there is in a shot, the shorter it should be. Shots with fast movements can be longer. Long shots have more content, so they should also be shown longer.

All the editing practices of the Hollywood grammar were designed to permit seamless transitions from shot to shot and to concentrate attention on the action at hand. What helped to maintain immediacy and the flow of the action was good; what did not was bad.



Vsevolod Illarionovich **Pudovkin** was a Soviet film director, screenwriter and actor who developed influential theories of montage.

Basically, editing is about the way cinematic space is presented, the control of a series of graphics, and the control of time.

It's also about what you want to emphasise: the emotion? Facial expression? Dialogue? Or setting? Or action?

"The foundation of film art is editing." Pudovkin



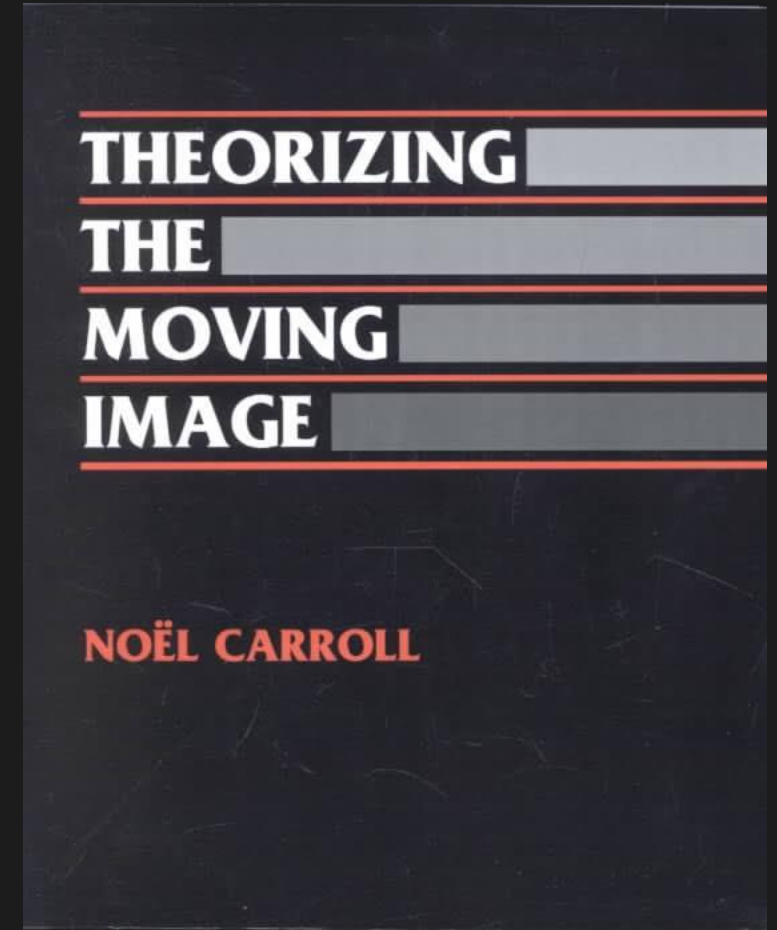
1929 1st edition

Carroll presents here two aspects or problems: editing as a means of communication, and the false understanding of editing as a language.

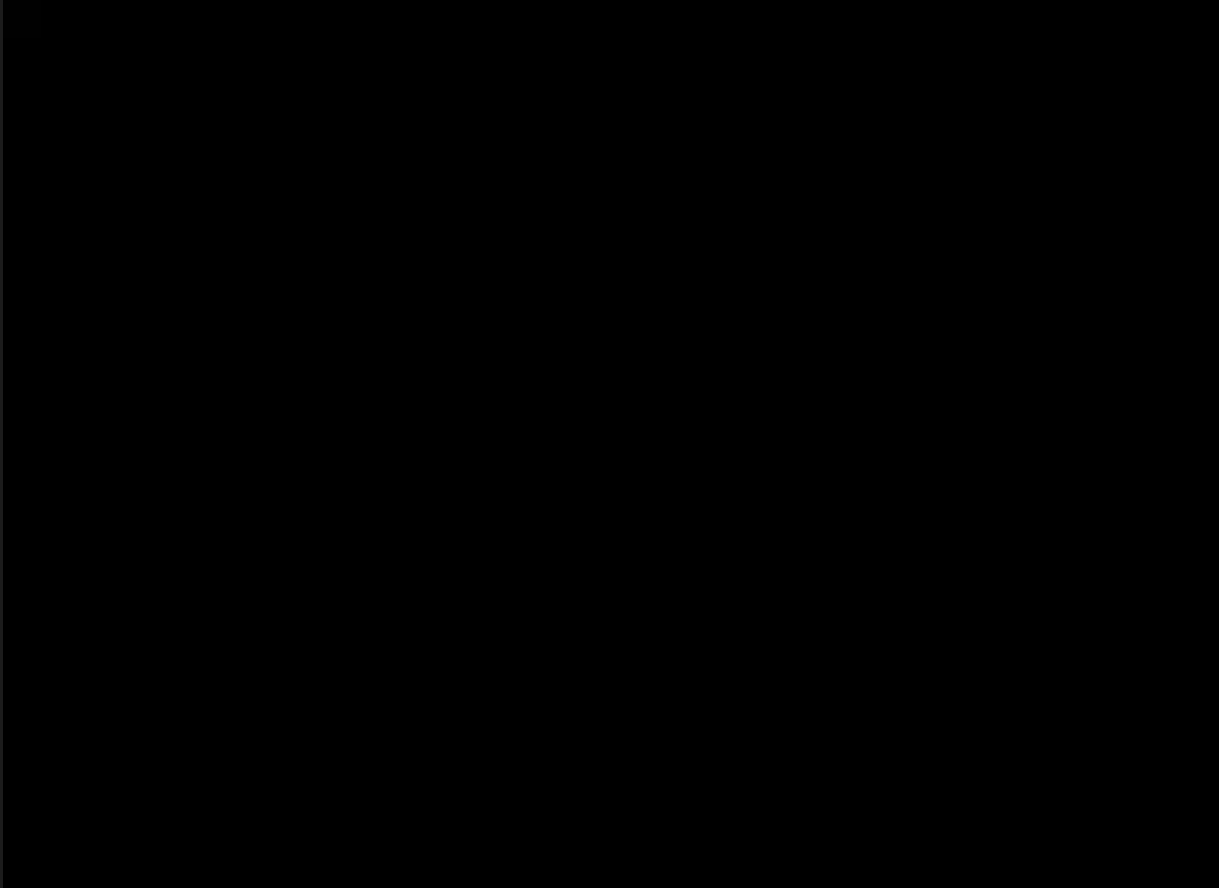
Main argument: Editing is a means of articulation in film communication (p. 403).

Noël Carroll: *Theorizing the Moving Image* (1996)

“The material basis of film editing is the cut, the physical joining of two shots. We can easily account for this process with a little chemistry. Of course there is also in-camera editing. To discuss this we have to add some mechanics to our story. But editing involves more than chemistry and mechanics. It is a means of communication within the social institution of world cinema. It provides a means of articulation whose practice enables filmmakers to convey stories, metaphors and even theories to spectators.”



Cinema History :



The Magician (Le Magicien) is a 1898 French short black-and-white silent trick film, directed by Georges Méliès, featuring a wizard, a Pierrot and a sculptor in a rapid series of jump cuts.

Early film theories' relation to film practice:

Those that focus first on the power of the filmmaker to modify or manipulate reality are, at base, Expressionist: that is, they are more concerned with the filmmaker's expression of the raw materials than with the filmed reality itself.

These two basic attitudes have dominated the history of film theory and practice ever since the Lumiere brothers (who seemed to be obsessed with capturing raw reality on film) and Méliès (who obviously was more interested by what he could do to his raw materials).

formalist film theory vs. realist film theory

Let's re-examine **the connection**
between mise-en-scene (the previous weekly topic) and editing/montage

The Semiology of the Cinema

You might have heard of film semiotics (another theoretical school, different from David Bordwell).

Roland Barthes, Umberto Eco, Christian Metz, Julia Kristeva, Algirdas Greimas, Peter Wollen.

To Bazin's question *What is Cinema?* Metz has replied cinema is a language.
Metz is the first to inform it with a sophisticated understanding of modern linguistics.

“In written/spoken language systems, **syntax** deals only with what we might call the linear aspect of construction: that is, the ways in which words are put together in a chain to form phrases and sentences, what in film we call the syntagmatic category. In film, however, syntax can also include spatial composition, for which there is no parallel in language systems like English and French—we can't say or write several things at the same time.

So film syntax must include both development in time and development in space. In film criticism, generally, the modification of space is referred to as "mise-en-scene." The French phrase literally means "putting in the scene." The modification of time is called "montage" (from the French for "putting together").

Over the years, theories of mise-en-scene have tended to be closely associated with film realism, while montage has been seen as essentially expressionistic, yet these pairings are deceptive. Certainly it would seem that mise-en-scene would indicate a high regard for the subject in front of the camera, while montage would give the filmmaker more control over the manipulation of the subject, **but despite these natural tendencies, there are many occasions when montage can be the more realistic of the two alternatives, and mise-en-scene the more expressionistic.** “

From James Monaco



This is one of the critical debates in early film scholarship.

It was Andre Bazin, the influential French critic of the 1950s, who more than anyone developed the connections between mise-en-scene and realism on the one hand, and montage and expressionism on the other.



At about the same time, in the middle fifties, Jean-Luc Godard was working out a synthesis of the twin notions of mise-en-scene and montage that was considerably more sophisticated than Bazin's binary opposition.

For Godard, mise-en-scene and montage were divested of ethical and aesthetic connotations: montage simply did in time what mise-en-scene did in space. Both are principles of organisation, and to say that mise-en-scene (space) is more "realistic" than montage (time) is illogical, according to Godard. In his essay "Montage, mon beau souci" (1956) Godard redefined montage as an integral part of mise-en-scene.



If editing is about putting shot in relation to another shot or other shots,

How many ways?

You may bump into many names.

Continuity editing, fade to black or white, cross cut, jump cut, match cut, smash cut,

J cut, L cut, montage, intellectual montage, double exposure, superimposition, dissolve, split screen, wipe, etc.



Editing:

The most common join is the **cut**. A cut provides an instantaneous change from one shot to another.

Other methods of joining shots produce more gradual changes:

A **fade-out** gradually darkens the end of a shot to black, and a **fade-in** lightens a shot from black.

A **dissolve** briefly superimposes the end of shot A and the beginning of shot B.

In a **wipe**, shot B replaces shot A by means of a boundary line moving across the screen (6.4).





In the final shot of Yorgos Lanthimos's film *The Favourite*, Emma Stone and Olivia Colman's faces are superimposed, slowly fading over one another.

The superimposition begins to conflate the identities of the Queen and Abigail, and indicates?

The Favourite (Yorgos Lanthimos, 2018)

When filmmakers want to pattern our experience so precisely, editing becomes an attractive stylistic option.

Editing offers the filmmaker **four basic areas of choice and control**:

1. Graphic relations between shot A and shot B
2. Rhythmic relations between shot A and shot B
3. Spatial relations between shot A and shot B
4. Temporal relations between shot A and shot B

1. Graphic Relations: Matches and Clashes

The four aspects of mise-en-scene (lighting, setting, costume, and the movement of the figures) and most cinematographic qualities (photography, framing, and camera mobility) all furnish **graphic elements**.



Graphics may be edited to achieve smooth continuity (for transitional moments) or abrupt contrast (conversation scene).

Also check “graphic match”
(cinematic composition, layers)

Hitchcock employs two types of contrast. First, his cutting contrasts the movement of Melanie’s head with the trail of flames. A second contrast is between movement and stillness. The shots of the flames show movement of both the subject and the camera, while the shots of Melanie’s head are completely static.



Breakfast sequence

Graphic discontinuity yields editing symmetry. *Pulp Fiction*: Vincent and Jules are at opposite ends of the screen in each shot, but the cutting creates an overall balance. It also offers our attention a predictable, left-right trajectory to follow.

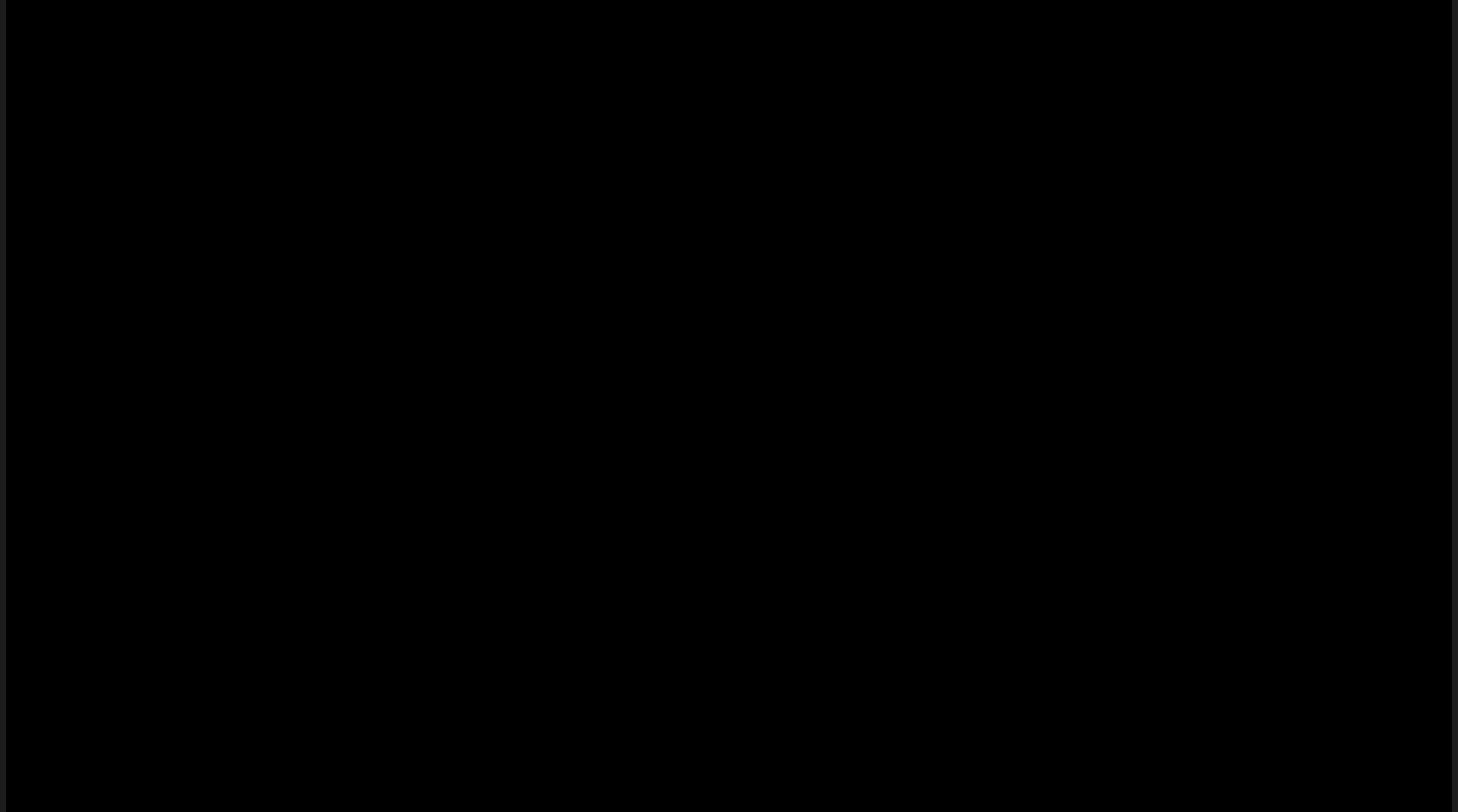
the overall effect is one of symmetry and balance.

2. Rhythmic Relations

Every shot is of a certain length, with its series of frames consuming a certain amount of time onscreen.

Lengthening shots can slow the rhythm, while shorter and shorter shots can accelerate it.

In general, by controlling editing rhythm, the filmmaker controls the amount of time we have to grasp and reflect on what we see.



3. Spatial Relations

- If you're the director, you might start with a shot that establishes a spatial whole and follow this with a shot of a part of this space.
- Alternatively, you could construct a whole space out of component parts.
- Think about whether you need an establishing shot or master shot when shooting/editing.

The Kuleshov effect is a film editing effect demonstrated by Russian film-maker Lev Kuleshov in the 1910s and 1920s. It is a mental phenomenon by which viewers derive more meaning from the interaction of two sequential shots than from a single shot in isolation.

Many filmmakers had already discovered this editing tactic, but because Kuleshov called attention to it, film historians called it the Kuleshov effect.

In general, that term refers to cutting together portions of a space in a way that prompts the spectator to assume a spatial whole that isn't shown onscreen. Most often, this happens because the filmmaker has decided to withhold an establishing shot



=HUNGER

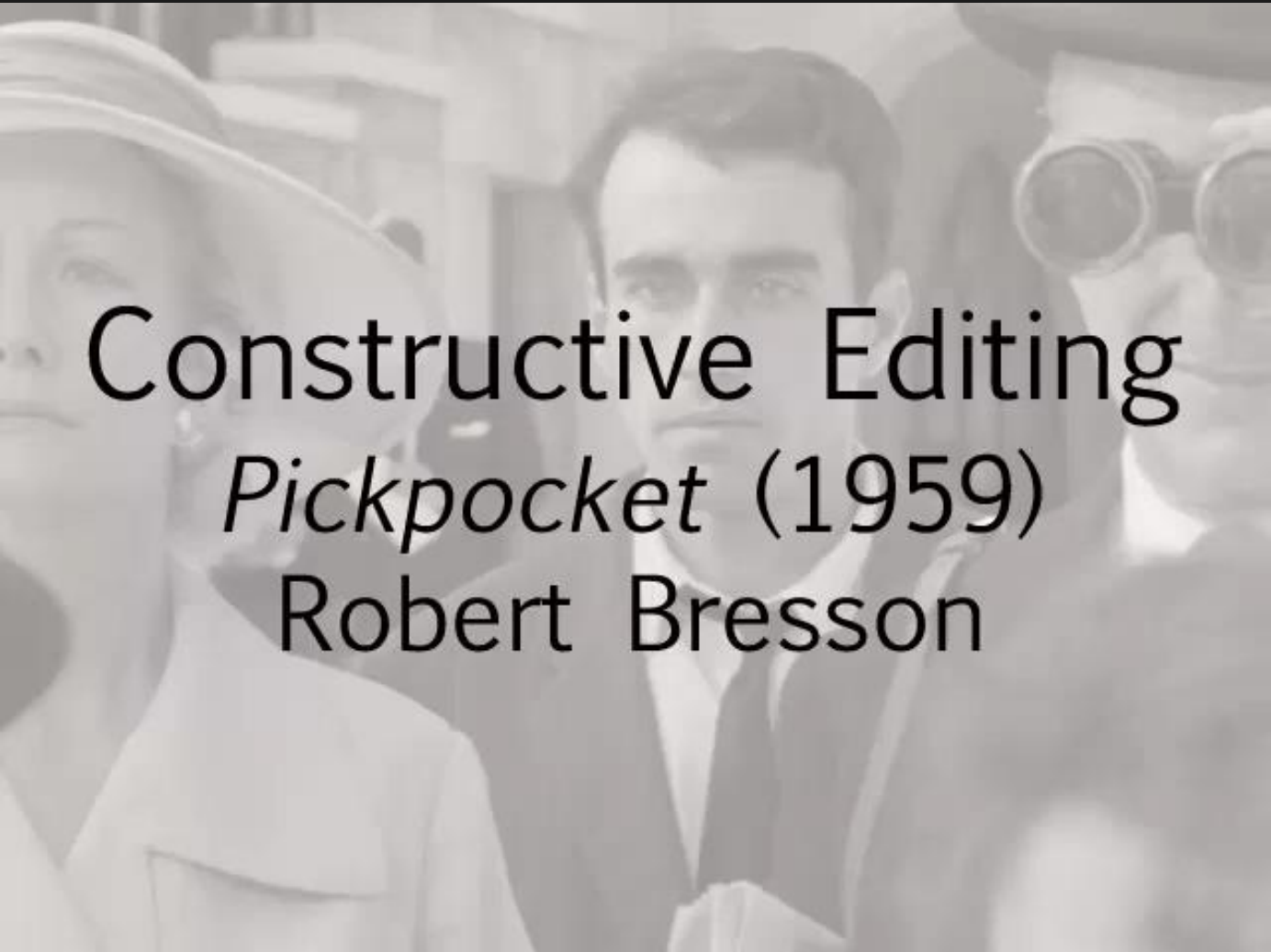


= SADNESS



=LUST

Space



Constructive Editing

Pickpocket (1959)

Robert Bresson

Constructive Editing that suggests a scene's space by providing only portions of it, without an establishing shot.

Also see DB's discussion of Constructive editing in Chapter 6

space

The video draws examples from silent films including Harold Lloyd's *Number, Please?* (1920) and Lev Kuleshov's *Engineer Prite's Project* (1918), while more recent examples include *The Social Network* and *The Ghost Writer*.

Chinese martial art films examples:
<http://www.davidbordwell.net/blog/category/technique-editing/>

A rectangular frame containing handwritten text in Cyrillic script. The text reads "Эррерк кыскада 1" (Erreerk kyskada 1) in a light, possibly white or light blue, ink. The handwriting is cursive and somewhat stylized. The background within the frame is dark and textured.

In general, that term refers to cutting together portions of a space in a way that prompts the spectator to assume a spatial whole that isn't shown onscreen. Most often, this happens because the filmmaker has decided to withhold an establishing shot.

This strategy is also called **constructive editing**, as opposed to **the analytical editing** that breaks an establishing shot into closer views.

4. Temporal Relations

- Editing can control the time of the action presented in the film.
- In a narrative film especially, editing usually contributes to the plot's manipulation of story time.
- Three ways that plot time can cue the spectator to construct the story time: **order, duration, and frequency.**



Order 1: Linear

Order 2: Flashforward

Sherlock Holmes: A Game of Shadows

: Holmes & Moriarty calculate their final battle in their minds.

Here the editing moves from the present to a future event and then returns to the present. Filmmakers may use flashforwards to tease the viewer with glimpses of the eventual outcome of the story action, or just the imagined outcome.

interrupt scenes in the present

Order 3: flashback



Titanic (1997)

memory motivates flashbacks to earlier story events.

Normally tells one's story in flashbacks, addressing key information for the narrative.

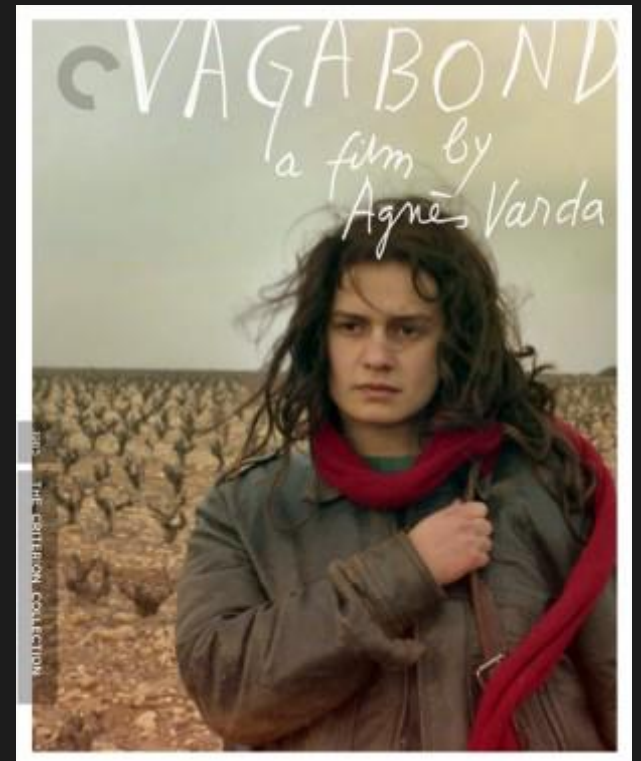
Duration : Editing can condense or expand duration

Filmmakers almost always present their shots in chronological order, but they're more likely to use editing to alter the *duration* of story events.

elliptical editing

- **Definition** : A cut between two shots which omits parts of an event, thus causing an ellipsis in the plot and story duration. So, it can also be called "elliptical cut".
- **Effect**: Often, an elliptical cut is used to create the impression that time has elapsed. The respective editing technique is called elliptical editing.
- **Why and when**: Filmmakers almost always present their shots in chronological order, but they're more likely to use editing to alter the duration of story events. Elliptical editing presents an action in such a way that it consumes less time on the screen than it does in the story.
- **Function**: makes it that an event's duration on-screen is shorter than its duration in the story and in character development.

Elliptical Editing
Vagabond (1985)
Agnès Varda





elliptical editing example



6.135



6.136



6.137

6.135–6.137 Elliptical cuts in *Wendy and Lucy*. Arrested for shoplifting, Wendy is worried about having left her dog Lucy at the supermarket. As she's fingerprinted, Wendy glances up, and an eyeline match shows the clock (6.135). A cut to the next shot shows Wendy in a cell, indicating that some minutes have elapsed (6.136). The clock shot functioned as a cut-away to cover a time gap. In the cell, another cut shows Wendy in a different position (6.137). This suggests that still more time has passed. An older film would have implied the passage of time through dissolves, but here the abrupt changes of locale and character position suggest the same thing. A later shot of the clock will show that Wendy has been held for at least two hours.

Even though jump cuts skip over some moments, they remain different from more common elliptical cuts. We saw an instance earlier, in the shots showing Wendy sitting in two positions on her cell bunk (6.136, 6.137). Those shots present two very different angles on the subject. A jump cut, however, shows the action from one angle or two very similar ones.

Slow motion is an effect in film-making whereby time appears to be slowed down.



In the Asian films, ambiguities present themselves straightforwardly as a contest between “traditional Confucian” values and more recent “modern Western” ones. When *The Wedding Banquet* (1993) ends with a freeze frame of the Chinese patriarch raising his hands, does this connote surrender or victory?

--Chris Berry



Match cut + slow motion

Fast editing/cutting



The Rock (1996)

We see faster rhythms everywhere

Intensified Continuity

Visual Style in Contemporary American Film

BD has a concern and asks:

Everybody thinks that movies are being cut faster now, but how fast is fast? And faster compared to what?

- Between 1930 and 1960, most Hollywood feature films, of whatever length, contained between 300 and 700 shots, so the **average shot length (ASL)** hovered around eight to **eleven seconds**.
- In the 1980s the tempo continued to pick up, but the filmmaker's range of choice narrowed dramatically. Double-digit ASLs, still found during the 1970s, virtually vanished from mass-entertainment cinema. Most ordinary films had ASLs between **five and seven seconds**.
- *The Crow* (1994), *U-Turn* (1997), and *Sleepy Hollow* (1999) came in at 2.7 seconds; *El Mariachi* (1993), *Armageddon*, and *South Park* (1999) at 2.3 seconds; and *Dark City* (1998), the fastest-cut Hollywood film I've found, at 1.8 seconds. In 1999 and 2000, the ASL of a typical film in any genre was likely to run **three to six seconds**.

Certainly, some action sequences are cut so fast (and staged so gracelessly) as to be incomprehensible. Nonetheless, many fast-cut sequences do remain spatially coherent.



Forest chase scene: Holmes (Robert Downey Jr.), Watson (Jude Law), and Simza (Noomi Rapace) make a daring escape through a forest

Every action director has his or her trademark: Tony Scott likes color, Michael Bay likes explosions, James Cameron pushes the effects envelope, John Woo loves a good Mexican standoff gone haywire (and doves, many many doves), Kathryn Bigelow likes to use slow-motion in action sequences, and Guy Ritchie likes to freeze the action entirely in what video essayist Semih Okmen refers to as “**locked shots.**”

The purpose of such shots, besides a flourish of style, is to accentuate the action by pausing it, giving us in the audience an opportunity to catch our breath and process, even for just a moment, the hyperactivity we’ve witnessed before being flung right back into it.

Editing Can Repeat Story Actions



Another example:
Money shot from porns.

In *Police Story*, chasing the gangsters through a shopping mall, Jackie Chan leaps onto a pole several stories above them. He slides down in a shower of exploding lights. Cut to a new angle: Jackie leaps again, leading to an instant replay of the risky stunt. While the *Strike* sequence briefly repeats bits of an action to extend a moment, this sequence from *Police Story* shows an entire action several times.

Many Conventions of editing

One of it: Continuity Editing

Graphics, rhythm, space, and time are at the service of the filmmaker through the technique of editing. They offer potentially unlimited creative possibilities, which is to say they offer a vast menu of choices. Yet most films we see make use of a more narrow set of editing possibilities. This menu of choices is called **continuity editing**, and it has dominated film history for a hundred years.

Around 1900–1910, as filmmakers started to explore editing, they tried to arrange their shots so as to tell a story clearly. They developed an approach to editing, supported by specific strategies of cinematography and mise-en-scene, that was based on narrative continuity. Their explorations coalesced into a consistent style at the end of the 1910s, and it was embraced by filmmakers around the world.

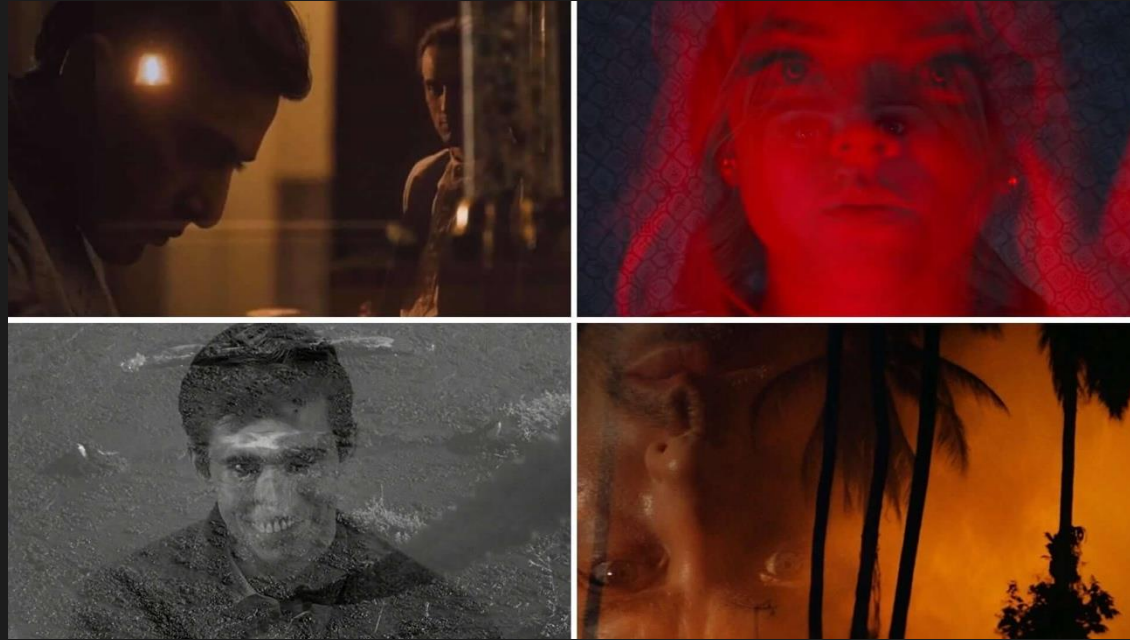
Watching 1930s and 1940s American films can introduce you to classical continuity style; try to predict what shot will come next in a sequence. (You'll be surprised at how often you're right.)

Let us be clear: what is continuity editing:

A system of cutting to maintain continuous and clear narrative action. Continuity editing relies on matching screen direction, position, and temporal relations from shot to shot. For specific techniques of continuity editing, see axis of action, crosscutting, cut-in, establishing shot, eyeline match, match on action, reestablishing shot, screen direction, shot/reverse shot.

Techniques of continuity editing in film

1. Eye line
2. Eye trace
3. The 180-degree rule
4. Match/cut on action
5. An establishing shot



Superimposition, by contrast, involves **overlaying multiple images on top of each other within the same frame**, often creating a ghostly or dreamlike effect. This technique **disrupts spatial and temporal unity** rather than preserving it, making it more common in **montage sequences, subjective experiences, or artistic editing styles**.

Superimposition is not typically considered part of continuity editing. Instead, it falls under the category of graphic or expressive editing techniques, often used in experimental, avant-garde, or stylistically expressive films.

At the theoretical level,

So, that's also why in the 1970s, we have *Screen Theory* (contemporary film theory)

- Male gaze
- The reflectionist model of representation (film mirrors the reality ×)
- “cinematic apparatus” (critique of ideology formation)
- Suture film theory

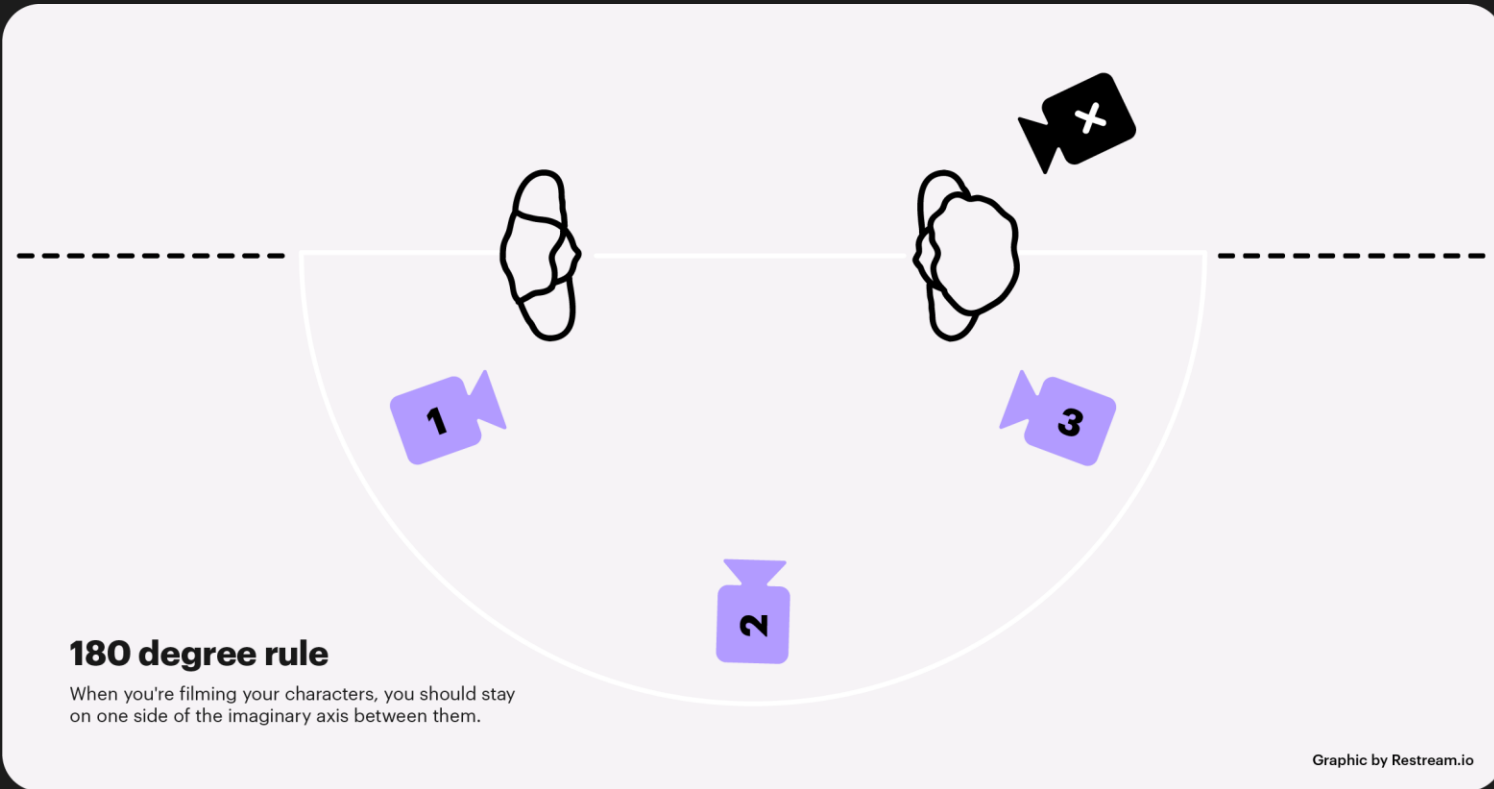
(According to suture film theory, the spectator is stitched into the world of cinema that is fabricated during the film process such that the result is subjects within the film which are drawn into the storyline.

As a result of this suturing, we experience a film according to the film's own terms. Therefore suture represents a critical term that can be used to further make sense of a film. A film sutures us, generally without necessarily suturing us into a particular position. However, we are generally sutured into a film through positive identification with a particular character or other real world elements of the story which we can relate with or otherwise identify with.)

Instead of taking representation as a means of reproducing what is real, representation serves as a point of departure. Cinematic texts are considered as manipulated by film scholars after the 1970s.

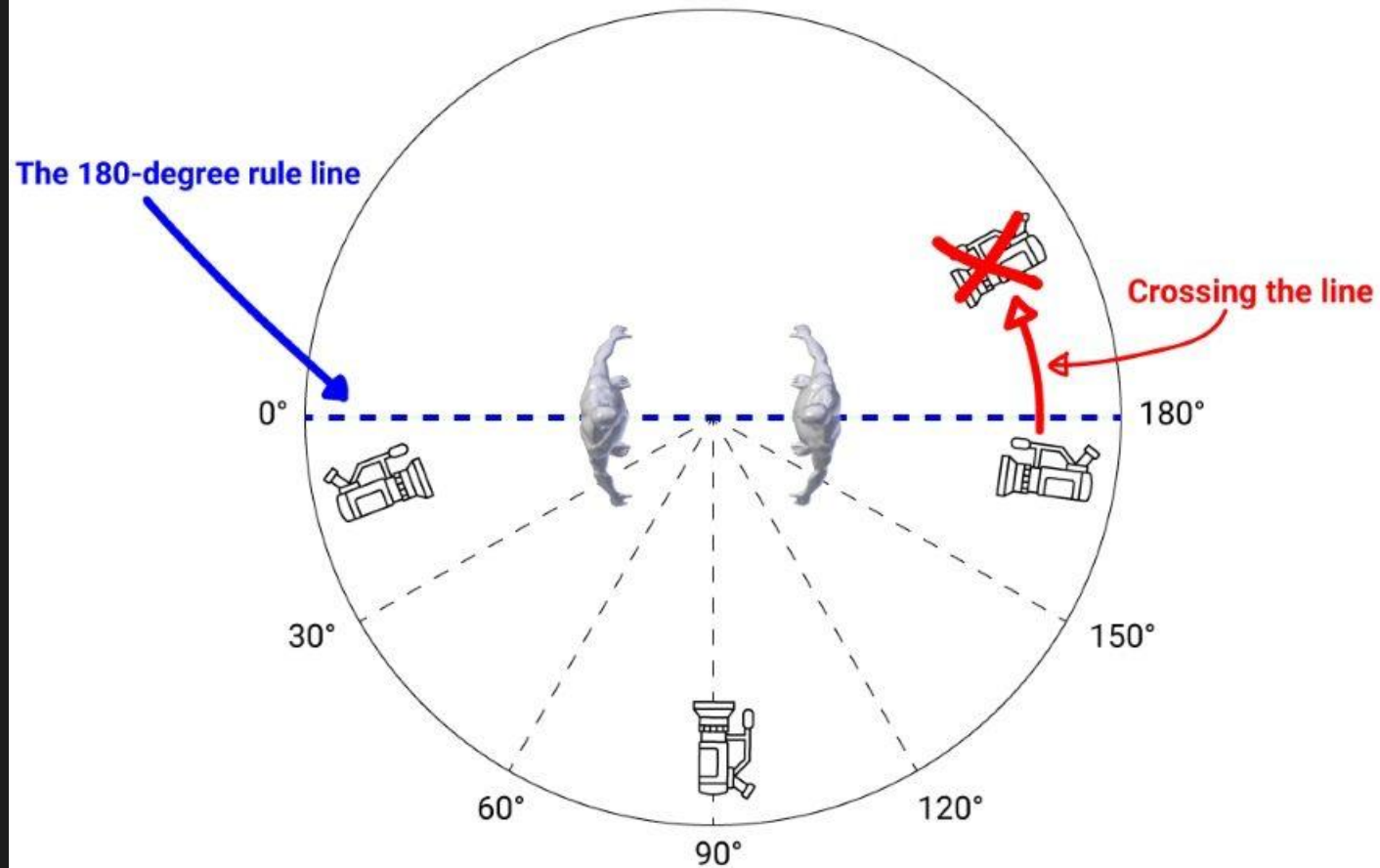
the 180-Degree Rule or 180-degree system: space continuity

- a cinematography principle that establishes **spatial relationships** between on-screen characters
- ensure that you consistently follow the 180-degree rule
- As the 180° system create the continuity



180° system The continuity approach to editing dictates that the camera should stay on one side of the action to ensure consistent left-right spatial relations between elements from shot to shot. The 180° line is the same as the axis of action.

The 180-degree rule



Under the continuity system, the director would arrange the mise-en-scene and camera placement so as to establish and sustain this line.

A typical series of shots for continuity editing of the scene would be these:

1. A medium shot of the girl and the boy in profile.
2. A shot over the girl's shoulder, favouring the boy.
3. A shot over the boy's shoulder, favouring the girl

The 180° system ensures that relative positions in the frame remain consistent.

The 180° system ensures consistent eyelines.

The 180° system ensures consistent screen direction.

Mainly because The viewer should always know where the characters are in relation to one another and to the setting



唐尼·阿索夫





She's Gotta Have It (1986) Thanksgiving Dinner at Nola's home
(the coloured version)

You can choose to not insert a master shot or delete the establishing shot.

The first shot, more or less from Nola's point of view, lays out the men's position at the table.

Sometimes a momentary axis of action is established between the men.

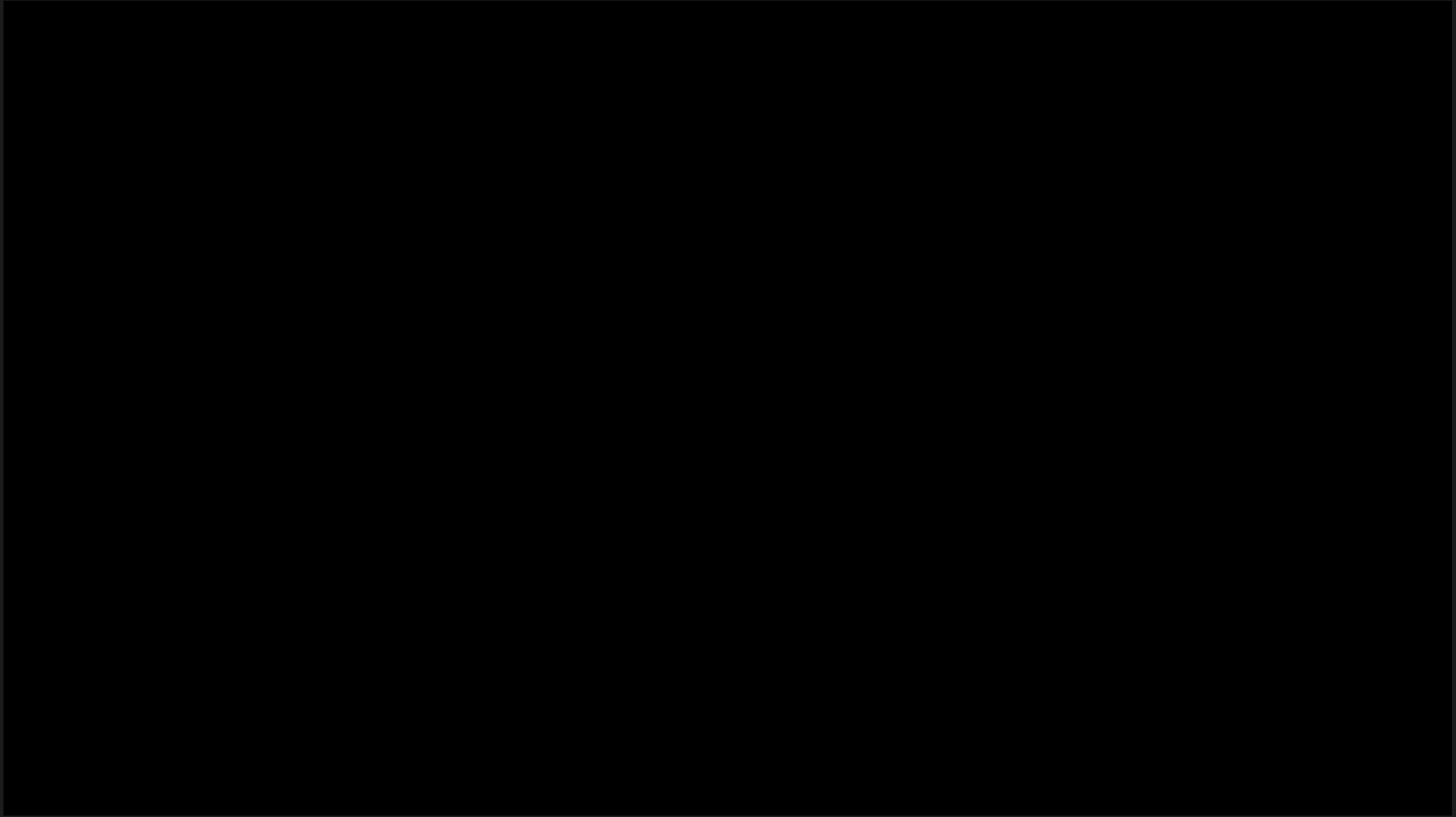
Nola is never shown in the same frame with her suitors, but her eyelines always tell us whom she's looking at (6.83). When the men look at her, each one's eyeline is consistent with their initial position at the table. In the last frame shown, we get an optical POV from Nola's position, as Greer addresses her directly.

The scene develops without an establishing shot showing all four characters.



Counter example:
Football match
Camera switch

To follow it is to give a sense or orientation for the viewer, the way the cameras are positioned in the above shot, when you cut to each individual it looks like they're looking at each other. Whereas, if a camera was placed across the 180-degree plane, it would feel a little off for viewers.



Pulp Fiction (1994)

Case 1: break the 180-degree rule



25th Hour (Spike Lee, 2002)

Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA) search home scene

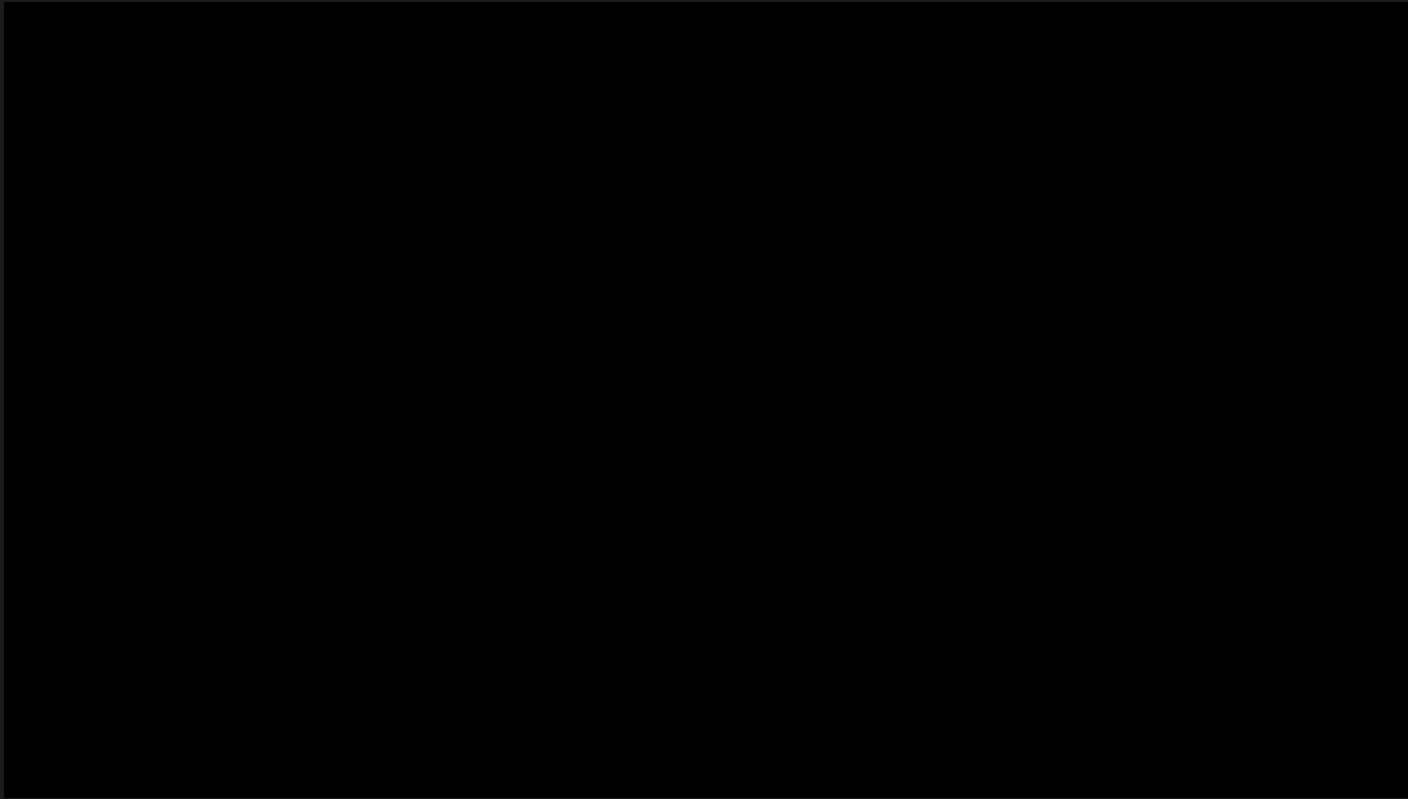
Case 2: bend the 180-degree rule



Ocean's Eleven (2001)

Case 3: hero shot

Every Michael Bay blockbuster which spins the camera around a chaotic fight scene, the rule is only being broken to help tell a greater story overall.



All the editing practices of the Hollywood grammar were designed to permit seamless transitions from shot to shot and to concentrate attention on the action at hand. What helped to maintain immediacy and the flow of the action was good; what did not was bad.

Montage

2nd convention

One form of ellipsis has persisted from the 1920s to the present. Sometimes the filmmaker wants to show a large-scale process or a lengthy period—a city waking up in the morning, a war, a child growing up. Here the filmmaker can pick another device from the menu: the montage sequence.

Because montage sequences usually lack dialogue, they tend to come wrapped in music.

So, what can be considered as a montage sequence? And when to use it?

A segment of a film that summarises a topic or compresses a passage of time into brief symbolic or typical images. Frequently, dissolves, fades, superimpositions, and wipes are used to link the images in a montage sequence.

Think about the hardworking sequence in *Legally Blonde*

In general parlance, "montage" is used in three different ways. While maintaining its basic meaning, it also has the more specific usages of:

1. a dialectical process that creates a third meaning out of the original two meanings of the adjacent shots;
2. a process in which a number of short shots are woven together to communicate a great deal of information in a short time.
3. This last is simply a special case of general montage; the dialectical process is inherent in any montage, conscious or not.



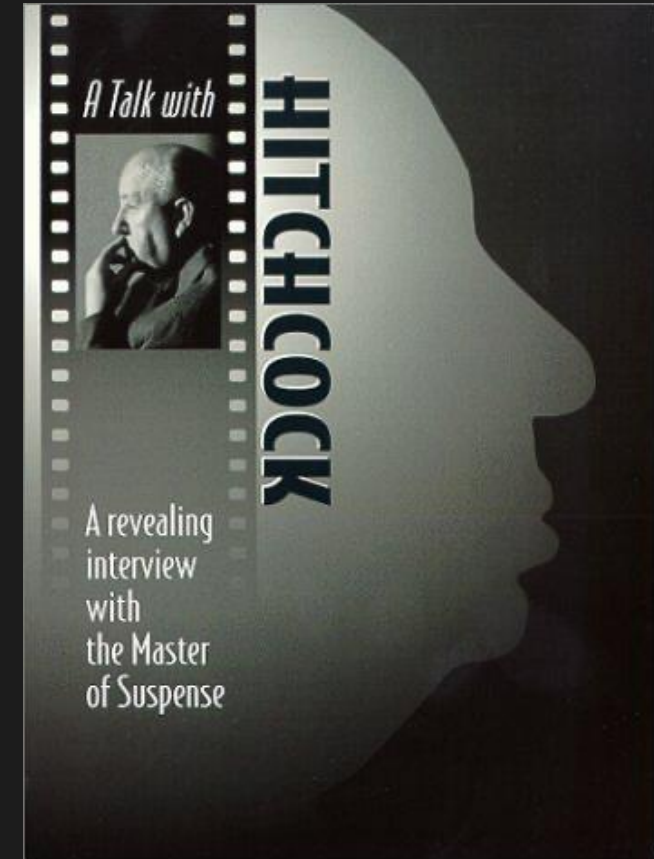
Time-lapse montage: to show the change...

The change of characters' relations or the character's experience of a change **in the character arc**

A character arc is the transformation or inner journey of a character over the course of a story. If a story has a character arc, the character begins as one sort of person and gradually transforms into a different sort of person in response to changing developments in the story.



For more detail, see



Hitchcock explains the Kuleshov Effect to Fletcher Markle in 1964

That's what a film can do for you.

Montage was first given central place in film theorizing by Pudovkin (1926) and Eisenstein (1963), and has remained a defining aspect of what constitutes film ever since.

- Eisenstein, Sergei (1963). *Film Form*. London: Dennis Dobson.
- Pudovkin, Vladimir (1926). *Film Technique and Film Acting*. New York: Bonanza.



Бойня.

The carnage.

Intellectual montage is when you edit two shots together to connect them to an intellectual concept.

Strike (1925)

This montage editing takes Shot A series (the cow) and joins it with Shot B series (the people) to create a third and higher meaning.

The juxtaposition of the cow being slaughter with the people being slaughter creates a visceral response in the viewer.



Sergei Eisenstein "Cinematographic Principle and the Ideogram"

In front of me lies a crumpled yellowed sheet of paper. On it is a mysterious note:

"Linkage—P" and "Collision—E."
A substantial trace of a heated bout on the subject of linkage between P (Pudovkin) and E (myself). This has become a habit. At regular intervals he visits me late at night and belligerent dogs wangle over matters of linkage. This is an understanding of montage as a linkage of pieces. Into a chain. Again, "bricks." Bricks, arranged in series to expound an idea.

I confronted him with my viewpoint on montage as a collision. A view that from the collision of two given factors arises a concept.

From my point of view, linkage is merely a possible special case.

Recall what an infinite number of combinations is known in physics to be capable of arising from the impact (collision) of spheres. Depending on whether the spheres be resilient, non-resilient, or mingled. Amongst all these combinations there is one in which the impact is so weak that the collision is degraded to an even movement of both in the same direction.

This is the one combination which would correspond with Pudovkin's view.

Not long ago we had another talk. Today he agrees with my point of view. True, during the interval he took the opportunity to acquaint himself with the series of lectures I gave during that period at the State Cinema Institute. . . .

So, montage is conflict.

As the basis of every art is conflict (an "imagist" transformation of the dialectical principle). The shot appears as the cell of montage. Therefore it also must be considered from the viewpoint of conflict.

Conflict within the shot is potential montage, in the development of its intensity shattering the quadrilateral cage of the shot and exploding its conflict into montage impulses between the montage pieces. As, in a zigzag of mimicry, the *mise-en-scène* splashes out into a spatial zigzag with the same shattering. As the slogan, "All obstacles are vain before Russians," bursts out in the multitude of incident of *War and Peace*.

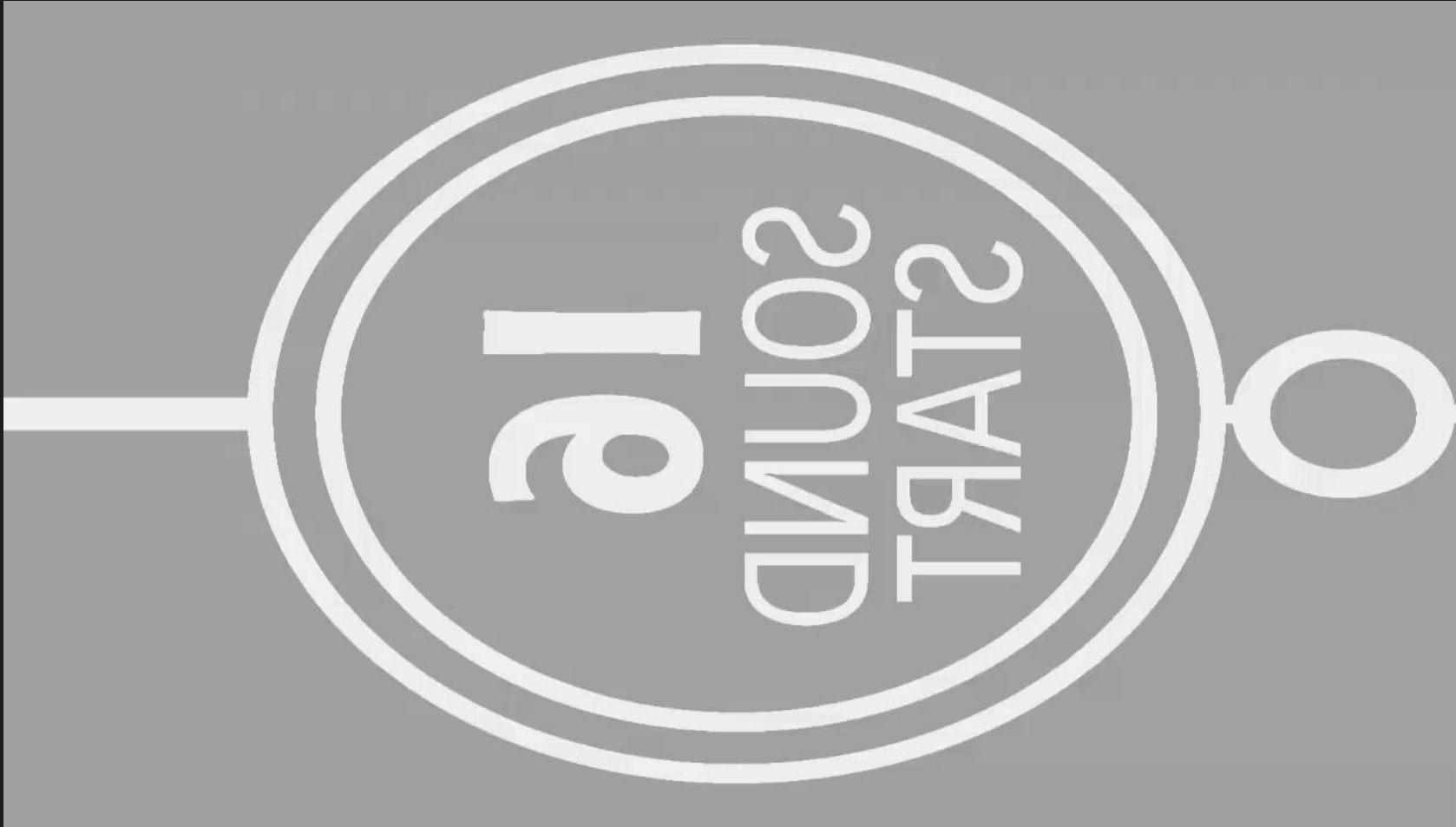
If montage is to be compared with something, then a phalanx of montage pieces, of shots, should be compared to the series of explosions of an internal combustion engine, driving forward its automobile or tractor: for, similarly, the dynamics of montage serve as impulses driving forward the total film.

Conflict within the frame. This can be very varied in charac-

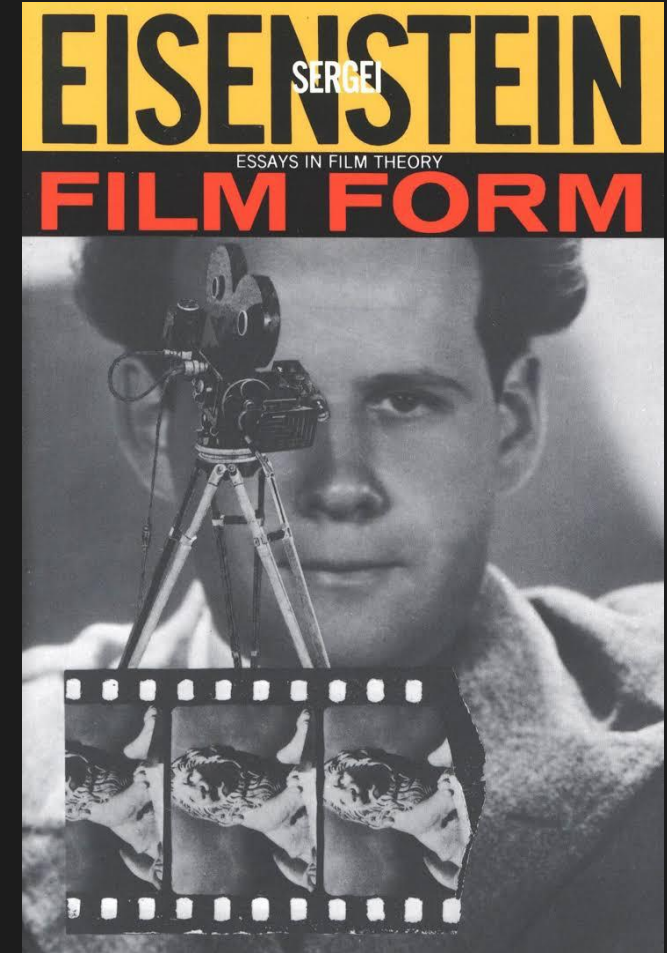


the Odessa Steps sequence in *The Battleship Potemkin*

Potemkin's centrepiece – the massacre on the Odessa steps – has become the most widely referenced sequence in film history and demonstrated the overlapping use of metric, rhythmic and tonal montage central to Eisenstein's early directorial work and cinema theory



famous Russian film theorist Sergei Eisenstein's famous five Methods of Montage contained in his seminal work, *Film Form: Essays in Film Theory* (1949 1st edition)





Mise-en-scene or montage?

A crucial scene in Bergman's *Face to Face*, this was shot from a hallway giving a "split screen" view of two rooms.



Split-screen editing/framing (multi frame) often present two or more events taking place at the same time.

So, when to stage your scene in split-screen?

- The telephone scene, the conversation, the dialogue happened.
- Split-screen presentation of phone conversations
- Modern filmmakers have turned to multiple-frame imagery to build suspense; we gain a godlike omniscience as we watch different story actions at exactly the same moment.